

# Rik Wanders

## Senior Full-Stack Developer

Building scalable web applications for remote teams

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## SUMMARY

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Dutch Senior Full-Stack Developer residing in Spain. 10+ years Python & Node.js experience, scaling complex, high-traffic & data heavy applications with Django & React, and leading development teams. Additional skills in DevOps, CI/CD & UXD. Current with industry trends, AI & security. Thrives in agile teams / startup environments. 5+ years remote work experience.

## WORK EXPERIENCE

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### Chipta | Amsterdam, NL | Lead Developer | 09/2015 - 03/2025

- Led distributed development team (3-5 devs) with agile methods and strict code review processes, optimizing team output
- Ensured uptime and performance of critical services (infra, apps, deployment) on platform with 10,000+ monthly active users

### Tender-it | Amsterdam, NL | Lead Developer | 06/2014 - 06/2015

- Delivered complete platform with Python, Django & React in consultation with non-technical founders
- Transformed thousands of tenders daily into structured data, by making web crawlers & importers with Django & Celery
- Developed industry-first Elasticsearch-powered search engine for filtering & scoring hundreds of thousands of tenders

### TravelBird | Amsterdam, NL | Senior Full-Stack Developer | 03/2013 - 08/2014

- Shipped iPhone & Android booking apps in scrum team (4) within 5 months, handling 15%+ of bookings in 3 months
- Designed REST API with JWT auth using DRF, deployed on AWS, accommodating iOS & Android apps and mobile website
- Supported acquisition by sending thousands of emails with marketing system using Python, Django, Celery & SendGrid

## SKILLS

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- **Backend:** Python | Django | Django REST Framework (DRF) | Flask | FastAPI | RESTful APIs | LLM integrations | pytest
- **Frontend:** JavaScript | Node.js | TypeScript | React Native | React | Svelte | Tailwind CSS | Jest
- **Databases:** PostgreSQL | MySQL | MariaDB | SQLite | SQL optimization | Elasticsearch | MongoDB | Redis
- **Development Tools:** Git | GitHub | Git Flow | Claude Code | Cursor | Neovim | tmux
- **DevOps:** Docker | Docker Compose | GitLab CI/CD | GitHub Actions | Ansible | Python Fabric | Caching strategies
- **Cloud Platforms:** Amazon Web Services | AWS EC2 | AWS S3 | AWS Lambda | Vercel | Linode
- **Dev Methodologies:** Agile | Scrum | XP | AI-Assisted Development | Secure by design | TDD | UXD

## SIDE PROJECTS

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### Smart Job Seeker | 07/2025 - Present

<https://github.com/gitaarik/smart-job-seeker>

An intelligent job search and application management platform that helps you create a detailed profile, discover matching opportunities, and optimize your job application process with AI assistance. Built with TypeScript, Sveltekit, Prisma ORM, Directus CMS, PostgreSQL, Docker Compose and Tailwind CSS.

### LitState | 11/2020 - 01/2023

<https://github.com/gitaarik/lit-state>

Reactive state management library for Lit Web Components, open-sourced on GitHub & NPM. Used in production at Chipta (ticket shop). Lit + LitState is a simpler, lightweight and browser-native alternative to React + Redux.

### Adyengo | 08/2013 - 05/2020

<https://github.com/gitaarik/adyengo>

Open-source Django package for Adyen payment integration with recurring payment support. Used in production at Tender-it.

### Monkful | 09/2013 - 10/2014

<https://github.com/gitaarik/monkful>

Python package to easily create RESTful API's for MongoEngine documents used for MongoDB database. Inspired by Django REST framework. Used in production at Travelbird.

## EDUCATION

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### Software Development, Dutch Vocational Education (MBO) | Nova College, Hoofddorp, NL

Comprehensive 4-year program including foundational computer science, algorithms, and data structures.

## LANGUAGES

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Dutch: Native

English: Fluent